

The question of deity Key philosophical and ethical concepts: • The nature of deity and Ultimate Reality in Hinduism • The existence of evil in the world • Human suffering	• Hindu understandings of the concept of deity - God, gods and Ultimate Reality including: ◦ Different Hindu teachings and beliefs about what Brahman is like ◦ Different Hindu teachings and beliefs about Brahman's relationship with the world ◦ Different Hindu teachings and beliefs about Brahman's relationship with humanity ◦ The role and significance of other deities ◦ Reasons for different views • The relationship between concepts of deity and Ultimate Reality • Hindu beliefs and views on Brahman and goodness	• Maya (delusion) • Cycle of samsara and rebirth within it • God as Ultimate Reality – Brahman and Atman • Nirguna and saguna Brahman • Shakti/Devi • Individual deities and the ways they are understood e.g. The Tri Murti/Tri Devi
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	• Hindu understandings of the meaning of goodness in the context of Brahman and the actions of deities in the world • Hindu beliefs, teachings and views on the relationship between God, gods and ultimate realities, and human suffering Learners should be aware of the justifications Hindus give for different views, attitudes and understandings, from the perspectives of different Hindu groups.	
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